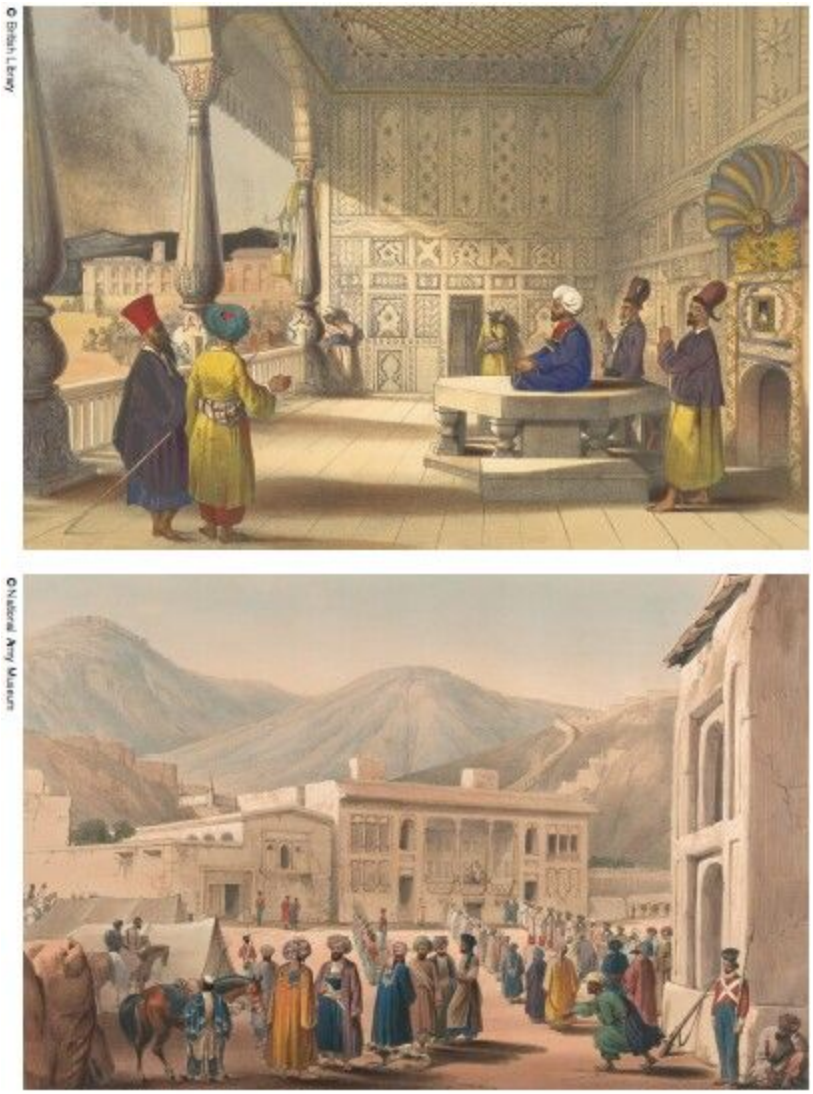


‘The Durbar-Khaneh of Shah Shoojah-ool-Moolk at Kabul.’ After the seizure of Ghazni, Dost Mohammad fled Kabul and Shuja was re-installed as Shah in August 1839. This Mughal-style reception hall in the Bala Hisar was where he would hold his durbars, and where he irritated his nobles and his British officers by making them stand for hours. As the British officer-turned-artist, Lockyer Willis Hart, noted: ‘This form and ceremony, so hateful to the Affghans, was the King’s foible, and sometimes carried to an absurd extent.’